

Town of Westhampton
Town Hall
1 South Road
Westhampton, MA 01027

Finance Committee Meeting Minutes
Tuesday, September 23, 2014

The meeting convened at 7:00 PM

Present:

Finance Committee Members: Ellice Gonzalez, Jackie Brodeur, Mary Cleary, Thomas Cleary, Jr., Maryanne Duggan, Aniko Giordano, Margaret Parsons, Celeste Whiting, Ed Zawacki.

1. Vote to accept minutes of FinCom meeting of 7/29/14. Vote 8-0-0.
2. Correspondence: The Beacon arrived. There will be a meeting of The Association of Town Finance Committees in Franklin, MA on October 18.
3. Old Business:

Highway Truck: As per the Selectboard minutes, the highway truck bids are in and the Selectboard voted to accept one of them. The budget for the highway truck was \$248,000. The accepted bid was \$239,000.

It was reported that the accountant's contract was not renewed and will expire September 30, 2014. Margaret Parsons was voted in as interim accountant.

According to Cheryl's report of the town audit, she expressed gratitude to all the Westhampton staff that helped provide information to the auditors.

Discussion of next steps for Westhampton's accounting and bookkeeping tasks. FinCom would like to have a representative be part of the search committee for a new staff person (role yet undefined). Celeste Whiting volunteered.

Free Cash update: It has not been certified. The accountant has not closed the books.

New Growth update: No information as of yet.

4. New Business:

Chapter 70 money: The chapter 70 money that the schools receive from the state came in at more than expected. Some surrounding towns thought that they could then appropriate the additional funds back to the town within the year. We clarified that towns cannot do that. No further action needed.

Ellice noted that Bridgid O’Riordon of the elementary school committee and Carl Norris of the regional school committee are supportive of the FinCom efforts to improve the school budget process.

5. Budget Process Review:

Ellice presented drafts of budget process calendar and draft budget request letter.

Aniko presented findings from her review of the FY15 budget process—a draft budget request template, budget status template and information from her review of the Finance Committee Handbook.

Mary presented findings from her review of the FY15 budget process— a timeline review of last year and notes of success, needs improvements and suggested guidelines for next year.

Due to time limitations, Celeste will hold off presenting her discussion with the Pelham Finance Committee until next meeting.

Mary and Aniko will work on a budget template and possible budget guidelines.

Our next meeting will be Tuesday, October 21 at 7:00 pm

Respectfully Submitted by Mary Cleary